

FIELD EDITION / MALABAR_COAST / 2026

2026 observing almanac

HORIZON	EDITION	SCOPE
Malabar Coast, India	2026	Night planning, Moon, Galactic Centre, planets and events

Priority observations

NO.	DATE	CATEGORY	OBSERVATION	RATING
01	26 Mar 2026	Milky Way	Milky Way core window 3h 56m with 50° altitude.	EXCELLENT
02	3 Aug 2026	Minor planets	4 Vesta 81° altitude; magnitude 7.5.	EXCELLENT
03	1 Jan 2026	Planets	Neptune Best monthly date at 73° altitude.	EXCELLENT
04	12 Aug 2026	Meteor showers	Perseids Peak conditions: 4% Moon illumination; 37° altitude predawn.	GOOD
05	1 Jan 2026	Comets	Comet 29P 75° altitude; magnitude 17.6.	GOOD
06	10 Jan 2026	Planetary events	Jupiter opposition Visible for most of the night.	GOOD

Monthly sheets give local dates and times. CSV tables: [data/index.html](#).

ANNUAL INDEX

Annual summary

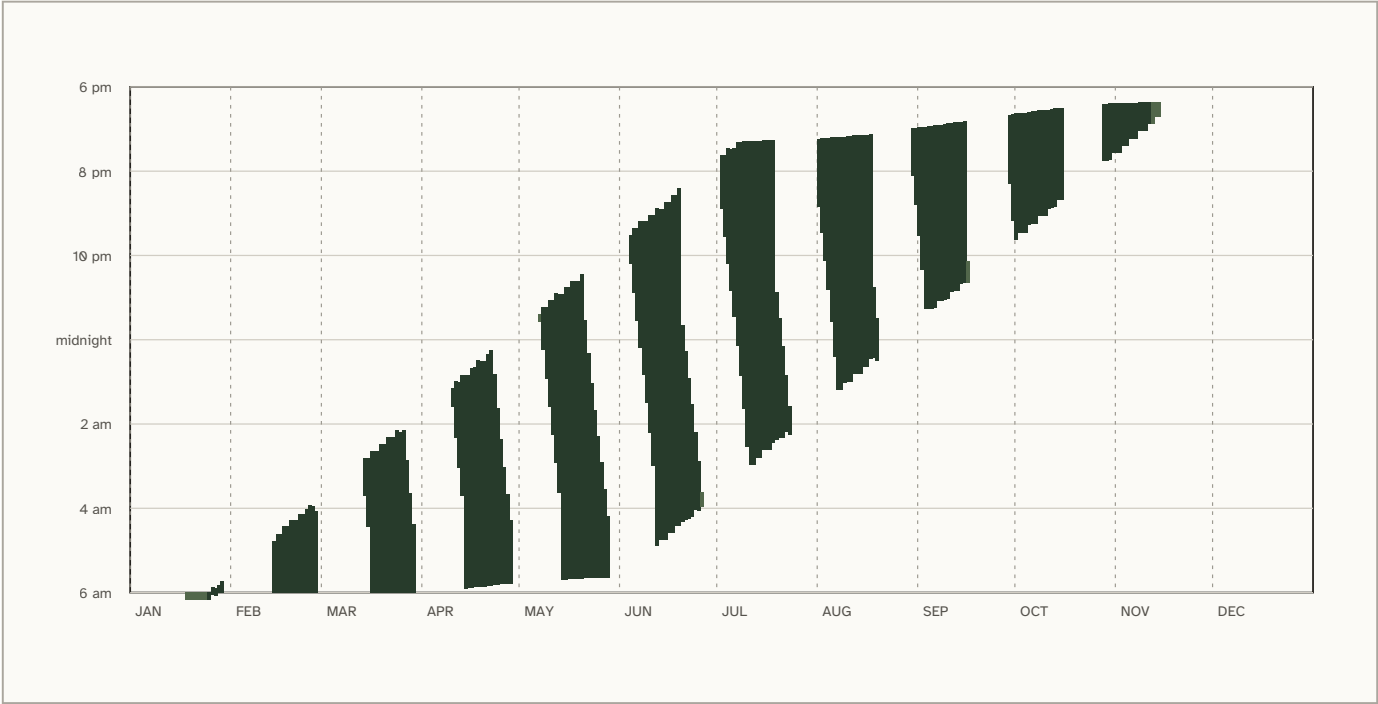
The principal observing lead, darkest low-Moon interval and darkest lunar date for each month.

MONTH	EVENT OR TARGET	BEST LOW-MOON DARKNESS	DARKEST MOON	RATING
01 JANUARY	PLANET OPPOSITION Jupiter reaches opposition on 11 Jan 2026 and is highest around 12:30 am.	15 Jan 2026 · 11h 42m	Darkest Moon 19 Jan 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
02 FEBRUARY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 27 Feb 2026, from 4:04 am to 6:21 am, reaching 44°.	14 Feb 2026 · 11h 30m	Darkest Moon 18 Feb 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
03 MARCH	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 26 Mar 2026, from 2:09 am to 6:05 am, reaching 50°.	16 Mar 2026 · 11h 13m	Darkest Moon 19 Mar 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
04 APRIL	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 21 Apr 2026, from 12:20 am to 5:50 am, reaching 50°.	14 Apr 2026 · 10h 54m	Darkest Moon 18 Apr 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
05 MAY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 20 May 2026, from 10:26 pm to 5:40 am, reaching 50°.	14 May 2026 · 10h 36m	Darkest Moon 17 May 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
06 JUNE	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 15 Jun 2026, from 8:44 pm to 4:44 am, reaching 50°.	12 Jun 2026 · 10h 26m	Darkest Moon 15 Jun 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
07 JULY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 11 Jul 2026, from 7:18 pm to 2:58 am, reaching 50°.	18 Jul 2026 · 10h 31m	Darkest Moon 15 Jul 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
08 AUGUST	METEOR SHOWER Perseids peak on 12 Aug 2026 under 4% Moon, with the radiant reaching about 37° before dawn.	17 Aug 2026 · 10h 47m	Darkest Moon 13 Aug 2026 · 1% illuminated	GOOD
09 SEPTEMBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Neptune reaches opposition on 26 Sep 2026 and is highest around 12:30 am.	15 Sep 2026 · 11h 05m	Darkest Moon 11 Sep 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
10 OCTOBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Saturn reaches opposition on 5 Oct 2026 and is highest around 12:30 am.	15 Oct 2026 · 11h 23m	Darkest Moon 11 Oct 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
11 NOVEMBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Uranus reaches opposition on 26 Nov 2026 and is highest around 12:00 am.	14 Nov 2026 · 11h 38m	Darkest Moon 9 Nov 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
12 DECEMBER	METEOR SHOWER Geminids peak on 14 Dec 2026 under 22% Moon, with the radiant reaching about 60° before dawn.	14 Dec 2026 · 11h 45m	Darkest Moon 9 Dec 2026 · 0% illuminated	GOOD

ANNUAL NIGHT CHART

Galactic Centre observing time

Each vertical trace is a usable core-viewing interval. Dates run left to right; local night time runs downward from 6 pm to 6 am.



Only intervals that pass astronomical darkness, Moon and core-altitude constraints are shown.

Best session by month

MONTH	DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALTITUDE	RATING
January	29 Jan 2026	5:44 am to 6:28 am	44m	28°	EXCELLENT
February	25 Feb 2026	3:55 am to 6:22 am	2h 27m	44°	EXCELLENT
March	24 Mar 2026	2:08 am to 6:07 am	3h 59m	50°	EXCELLENT
April	22 Apr 2026	12:14 am to 5:50 am	5h 36m	50°	EXCELLENT
May	20 May 2026	10:26 pm to 5:40 am	7h 13m	50°	EXCELLENT
June	15 Jun 2026	8:44 pm to 4:44 am	8h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT
July	11 Jul 2026	7:18 pm to 2:58 am	7h 40m	50°	EXCELLENT
August	7 Aug 2026	7:12 pm to 1:12 am	6h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT
September	4 Sep 2026	6:56 pm to 11:16 pm	4h 20m	50°	EXCELLENT
October	1 Oct 2026	6:38 pm to 9:38 pm	3h 00m	47°	EXCELLENT
November	1 Nov 2026	6:24 pm to 7:34 pm	1h 10m	32°	EXCELLENT
December	No qualifying session				

MONTH 01

January 2026

EXCELLENT

Jupiter reaches opposition on 11 Jan 2026 and is highest around 12:30 am.

NEW MOON 19 Jan 2026	FULL MOON 4 Jan 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jan 2026	DARKNESS 6:45 pm to 6:27 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
15 Jan 2026	6:45 pm to 6:27 am	11h 42m	20%
16 Jan 2026	6:45 pm to 6:27 am	11h 41m	13%
17 Jan 2026	6:46 pm to 6:27 am	11h 41m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
29 Jan 2026	5:44 am to 6:28 am	44m	28°	EXCELLENT
28 Jan 2026	5:49 am to 6:28 am	40m	27°	EXCELLENT
26 Jan 2026	5:53 am to 6:28 am	36m	26°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Uranus	30 Jan 7:30 pm	82°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Neptune	1 Jan 6:30 pm	73°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	1 Jan 6:30 pm	69°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Jupiter	5 Jan 1:00 am	79°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mercury	1 Jan 6:30 am	7°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
1 Jan 2026	Minor planets	7 Iris	74° altitude; magnitude 9.9.	EXCELLENT
1 Jan 2026	Comets	Comet 29P	75° altitude; magnitude 17.6.	GOOD
10 Jan 2026	Planetary events	Jupiter opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD

MONTH 02

February 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 27 Feb 2026, from 4:04 am to 6:21 am, reaching 44°.

NEW MOON 18 Feb 2026	FULL MOON 2 Feb 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Feb 2026	DARKNESS 6:56 pm to 6:25 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
14 Feb 2026	6:56 pm to 6:26 am	11h 30m	20%
15 Feb 2026	6:56 pm to 6:25 am	11h 29m	12%
16 Feb 2026	6:56 pm to 6:25 am	11h 29m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
25 Feb 2026	3:55 am to 6:22 am	2h 27m	44°	EXCELLENT
26 Feb 2026	3:57 am to 6:21 am	2h 25m	44°	EXCELLENT
24 Feb 2026	4:01 am to 6:22 am	2h 22m	44°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Uranus	6 Feb 7:00 pm	82°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Neptune	1 Feb 7:00 pm	39°	GOOD
Evening	Saturn	1 Feb 7:00 pm	38°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	19 Feb 7:00 pm	11°	POOR
Evening	Venus	28 Feb 7:00 pm	6°	POOR
Overnight	Jupiter	1 Feb 11:00 pm	79°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	26 Feb 6:30 am	5°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
24 Feb 2026	Comets	Comet 24P	85° altitude; magnitude 14.6.	GOOD
20 Feb 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest eastern elongation	Evening sky; 18.1° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Feb 2026	Occultations	HIP 38752 lunar occultation	12:49 am; Moon at 69° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 03

March 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 26 Mar 2026, from 2:09 am to 6:05 am, reaching 50°.

NEW MOON 19 Mar 2026	FULL MOON 4 Mar 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Mar 2026	DARKNESS 6:59 pm to 6:12 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
16 Mar 2026	6:59 pm to 6:12 am	11h 13m	18%
17 Mar 2026	6:59 pm to 6:11 am	11h 12m	10%
18 Mar 2026	6:59 pm to 6:10 am	11h 12m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
24 Mar 2026	2:08 am to 6:07 am	3h 59m	50°	EXCELLENT
26 Mar 2026	2:09 am to 6:05 am	3h 57m	50°	EXCELLENT
25 Mar 2026	2:11 am to 6:06 am	3h 56m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	31 Mar 7:00 pm	78°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Uranus	1 Mar 7:00 pm	67°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	1 Mar 7:00 pm	14°	POOR
Evening	Venus	31 Mar 7:00 pm	14°	POOR
Evening	Neptune	1 Mar 7:00 pm	13°	POOR
Predawn	Mercury	31 Mar 6:00 am	15°	POOR
Predawn	Mars	31 Mar 6:00 am	7°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
1 Mar 2026	Occultations	HIP 46149 lunar occultation	8:07 pm to 8:45 pm; Moon at 44° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
12 Mar 2026	Planetary events	Jupiter stationary point	Apparent motion changes direction.	FAIR
4 Mar 2026	Occultations	HIP 58093 lunar occultation	10:16 pm to 11:32 pm; Moon at 40° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 04

April 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 21 Apr 2026, from 12:20 am to 5:50 am, reaching 50°.

NEW MOON 18 Apr 2026	FULL MOON 2 Apr 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Apr 2026	DARKNESS 7:00 pm to 5:53 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
14 Apr 2026	7:00 pm to 5:54 am	10h 54m	22%
15 Apr 2026	7:00 pm to 5:53 am	10h 54m	14%
16 Apr 2026	7:00 pm to 5:53 am	10h 53m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
22 Apr 2026	12:14 am to 5:50 am	5h 36m	50°	EXCELLENT
21 Apr 2026	12:20 am to 5:50 am	5h 30m	50°	EXCELLENT
18 Apr 2026	12:30 am to 5:52 am	5h 22m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	1 Apr 7:00 pm	78°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Uranus	1 Apr 7:00 pm	40°	GOOD
Evening	Venus	30 Apr 7:00 pm	22°	FAIR
Predawn	Neptune	30 Apr 5:30 am	20°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	7 Apr 6:00 am	16°	FAIR
Predawn	Saturn	30 Apr 5:30 am	15°	POOR
Predawn	Mars	19 Apr 6:00 am	14°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
5 Apr 2026	Comets	Comet 3D	63° altitude; magnitude 15.8.	GOOD
4 Apr 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 27.8° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Apr 2026	Occultations	HIP 57306 lunar occultation	4:11 am to 4:20 am; Moon at 20° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 05

May 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 20 May 2026, from 10:26 pm to 5:40 am, reaching 50°.

NEW MOON 17 May 2026	FULL MOON 2 May 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 May 2026	DARKNESS 7:05 pm to 5:41 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
14 May 2026	7:05 pm to 5:41 am	10h 36m	18%
15 May 2026	7:05 pm to 5:41 am	10h 36m	10%
16 May 2026	7:05 pm to 5:40 am	10h 35m	4%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
20 May 2026	10:26 pm to 5:40 am	7h 13m	50°	EXCELLENT
17 May 2026	10:36 pm to 5:40 am	7h 05m	50°	EXCELLENT
18 May 2026	10:36 pm to 5:40 am	7h 04m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	1 May 7:00 pm	62°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Venus	28 May 7:00 pm	30°	GOOD
Evening	Uranus	1 May 7:00 pm	13°	POOR
Evening	Mercury	28 May 7:00 pm	12°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	31 May 5:30 am	49°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	31 May 5:30 am	42°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 May 5:30 am	19°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
1 May 2026	Occultations	HIP 67139 lunar occultation	1:36 am to 3:02 am; Moon at 50° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
6 May 2026	Meteor showers	Eta Aquariids	Peak conditions: 88% Moon illumination; 28° altitude predawn.	POOR
1 May 2026	Occultations	HIP 67328 lunar occultation	3:31 am to 4:43 am; Moon at 27° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 06

June 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 15 Jun 2026, from 8:44 pm to 4:44 am, reaching 50°.

NEW MOON 15 Jun 2026	FULL MOON 1 Jun 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jun 2026	DARKNESS 7:14 pm to 5:40 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
12 Jun 2026	7:13 pm to 5:39 am	10h 26m	21%
13 Jun 2026	7:14 pm to 5:39 am	10h 26m	13%
14 Jun 2026	7:14 pm to 5:40 am	10h 26m	6%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
15 Jun 2026	8:44 pm to 4:44 am	8h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT
19 Jun 2026	8:25 pm to 4:25 am	8h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT
12 Jun 2026	8:53 pm to 4:53 am	8h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	1 Jun 7:30 pm	32°	GOOD
Evening	Venus	30 Jun 7:30 pm	30°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	15 Jun 7:30 pm	14°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	30 Jun 5:30 am	75°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	30 Jun 5:30 am	69°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	30 Jun 5:30 am	27°	GOOD
Predawn	Uranus	30 Jun 5:30 am	25°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
6 Jun 2026	Minor planets	3 Juno	65° altitude; magnitude 10.0.	EXCELLENT
16 Jun 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest eastern elongation	Evening sky; 24.5° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Jun 2026	Occultations	HIP 82458 lunar occultation	1:31 am; Moon at 49° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 07

July 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 11 Jul 2026, from 7:18 pm to 2:58 am, reaching 50°.

NEW MOON 15 Jul 2026	FULL MOON 30 Jul 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jul 2026	DARKNESS 7:17 pm to 5:47 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
18 Jul 2026	7:17 pm to 5:48 am	10h 31m	19%
17 Jul 2026	7:17 pm to 5:48 am	10h 31m	11%
16 Jul 2026	7:17 pm to 5:48 am	10h 30m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
11 Jul 2026	7:18 pm to 2:58 am	7h 40m	50°	EXCELLENT
12 Jul 2026	7:18 pm to 2:58 am	7h 40m	50°	EXCELLENT
13 Jul 2026	7:18 pm to 2:48 am	7h 30m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	11 Jul 7:30 pm	31°	GOOD
Evening	Jupiter	1 Jul 7:30 pm	11°	POOR
Predawn	Saturn	21 Jul 5:30 am	82°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Neptune	11 Jul 5:30 am	79°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Uranus	31 Jul 6:00 am	59°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	31 Jul 6:00 am	41°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	31 Jul 6:00 am	15°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
28 Jul 2026	Minor planets	2 Pallas	80° altitude; magnitude 9.6.	EXCELLENT
1 Jul 2026	Occultations	HIP 95177 lunar occultation	2:57 am to 3:42 am; Moon at 45° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
8 Jul 2026	Planetary events	Neptune stationary point	Apparent motion changes direction.	FAIR

MONTH 08

August 2026

GOOD

Perseids peak on 12 Aug 2026 under 4% Moon, with the radiant reaching about 37° before dawn.

NEW MOON 13 Aug 2026	FULL MOON 29 Aug 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Aug 2026	DARKNESS 7:08 pm to 5:54 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
17 Aug 2026	7:07 pm to 5:54 am	10h 47m	23%
16 Aug 2026	7:08 pm to 5:54 am	10h 46m	15%
15 Aug 2026	7:08 pm to 5:54 am	10h 46m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
7 Aug 2026	7:12 pm to 1:12 am	6h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT
8 Aug 2026	7:11 pm to 1:11 am	6h 00m	50°	EXCELLENT
9 Aug 2026	7:11 pm to 1:01 am	5h 50m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	15 Aug 7:00 pm	33°	GOOD
Predawn	Saturn	5 Aug 4:30 am	82°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Uranus	31 Aug 6:00 am	80°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Neptune	3 Aug 4:00 am	79°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	31 Aug 6:00 am	49°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Jupiter	31 Aug 6:00 am	19°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	2 Aug 6:00 am	15°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
3 Aug 2026	Minor planets	4 Vesta	81° altitude; magnitude 7.5.	EXCELLENT
12 Aug 2026	Meteor showers	Perseids	Peak conditions: 4% Moon illumination; 37° altitude predawn.	GOOD
2 Aug 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 19.5° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 09

September 2026

EXCELLENT

Neptune reaches opposition on 26 Sep 2026 and is highest around 12:30 am.

NEW MOON 11 Sep 2026	FULL MOON 27 Sep 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Sep 2026	DARKNESS 6:49 pm to 5:54 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
15 Sep 2026	6:49 pm to 5:54 am	11h 05m	18%
14 Sep 2026	6:50 pm to 5:54 am	11h 05m	11%
13 Sep 2026	6:50 pm to 5:54 am	11h 04m	6%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
4 Sep 2026	6:56 pm to 11:16 pm	4h 20m	50°	EXCELLENT
5 Sep 2026	6:56 pm to 11:16 pm	4h 20m	50°	EXCELLENT
6 Sep 2026	6:55 pm to 11:15 pm	4h 20m	50°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	1 Sep 7:00 pm	27°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	30 Sep 7:00 pm	7°	POOR
Overnight	Saturn	3 Sep 2:30 am	82°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Neptune	1 Sep 2:00 am	79°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Uranus	24 Sep 4:30 am	80°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	30 Sep 6:00 am	58°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Jupiter	30 Sep 6:00 am	41°	GOOD

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
14 Sep 2026	Occultations	Venus lunar occultation	5:20 pm to 6:45 pm; Moon at 42° altitude for the first listed contact.	GOOD
26 Sep 2026	Planetary events	Neptune opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
4 Sep 2026	Occultations	HIP 19182 lunar occultation	12:24 am; Moon at 14° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 10

October 2026

EXCELLENT

Saturn reaches opposition on 5 Oct 2026 and is highest around 12:30 am.

NEW MOON 11 Oct 2026	FULL MOON 26 Oct 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Oct 2026	DARKNESS 6:30 pm to 5:54 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
15 Oct 2026	6:30 pm to 5:54 am	11h 23m	20%
14 Oct 2026	6:31 pm to 5:54 am	11h 23m	14%
13 Oct 2026	6:31 pm to 5:54 am	11h 22m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
1 Oct 2026	6:38 pm to 9:38 pm	3h 00m	47°	EXCELLENT
2 Oct 2026	6:38 pm to 9:28 pm	2h 50m	46°	EXCELLENT
3 Oct 2026	6:37 pm to 9:27 pm	2h 50m	46°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	2 Oct 6:30 pm	15°	FAIR
Evening	Mercury	6 Oct 6:30 pm	14°	POOR
Overnight	Saturn	2 Oct 12:30 am	81°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	31 Oct 2:00 am	80°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Neptune	1 Oct 12:00 am	79°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	31 Oct 6:00 am	71°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Jupiter	31 Oct 6:00 am	66°	EXCELLENT

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
4 Oct 2026	Planetary events	Saturn opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
21 Oct 2026	Meteor showers	Orionids	Peak conditions: 71% Moon illumination; 77° altitude predawn.	FAIR
1 Oct 2026	Occultations	HIP 18106 lunar occultation	12:05 am to 12:33 am; Moon at 37° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 11

November 2026

EXCELLENT

Uranus reaches opposition on 26 Nov 2026 and is highest around 12:00 am.

NEW MOON 9 Nov 2026	FULL MOON 25 Nov 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Nov 2026	DARKNESS 6:22 pm to 6:00 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
14 Nov 2026	6:22 pm to 5:59 am	11h 38m	21%
13 Nov 2026	6:22 pm to 5:59 am	11h 37m	15%
12 Nov 2026	6:22 pm to 5:59 am	11h 37m	9%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
1 Nov 2026	6:24 pm to 7:34 pm	1h 10m	32°	EXCELLENT
2 Nov 2026	6:24 pm to 7:34 pm	1h 10m	31°	EXCELLENT
3 Nov 2026	6:23 pm to 7:23 pm	1h 00m	31°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	7 Nov 9:30 pm	78°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	30 Nov 12:00 am	81°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Saturn	6 Nov 10:00 pm	80°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Jupiter	27 Nov 6:00 am	88°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	30 Nov 6:00 am	87°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Venus	30 Nov 6:00 am	33°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	20 Nov 6:00 am	13°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
15 Nov 2026	Minor planets	1 Ceres	71° altitude; magnitude 8.0.	EXCELLENT
3 Nov 2026	Occultations	Jupiter lunar occultation	2:24 am to 3:08 am; Moon at 17° altitude for the first listed contact.	GOOD
21 Nov 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 19.6° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 12

December 2026

GOOD

Geminids peak on 14 Dec 2026 under 22% Moon, with the radiant reaching about 60° before dawn.

NEW MOON 9 Dec 2026	FULL MOON 24 Dec 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Dec 2026	DARKNESS 6:29 pm to 6:14 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
14 Dec 2026	6:29 pm to 6:13 am	11h 45m	22%
13 Dec 2026	6:28 pm to 6:13 am	11h 44m	15%
12 Dec 2026	6:28 pm to 6:12 am	11h 44m	10%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
No qualifying core session is listed.				

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Saturn	29 Dec 6:30 pm	80°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Neptune	22 Dec 6:30 pm	78°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	28 Dec 10:00 pm	81°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	25 Dec 5:00 am	90°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Jupiter	5 Dec 5:30 am	88°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Venus	28 Dec 6:30 am	42°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	1 Dec 6:00 am	9°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
14 Dec 2026	Meteor showers	Geminids	Peak conditions: 22% Moon illumination; 60° altitude predawn.	GOOD
1 Dec 2026	Occultations	HIP 51008 lunar occultation	3:36 am to 4:35 am; Moon at 51° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
11 Dec 2026	Planetary events	Saturn stationary point	Apparent motion changes direction.	FAIR

REFERENCE

Using this field edition

Time and place

All displayed dates and times are local to Malabar Coast, India. Overnight intervals begin on the printed date and may end after midnight on the following civil date.

Ratings

Text labels repeat every colour-coded rating for monochrome printing.

Low-Moon darkness

Intervals occur within astronomical darkness and apply the edition's Moon constraint. They are not interchangeable with Galactic Centre visibility, which additionally requires the core to clear the altitude threshold.

CSV tables

Full CSV tables for twilight, Moon, Galactic Centre, planets, satellites, minor planets, comets and events are available from the web data index.

Sources and scope

- Solar, lunar, planetary and Galactic Centre circumstances are calculated for the named observing horizon.
- Jupiter and Saturn satellite positions use NASA JPL Horizons.
- Meteor and event sources are listed in the downloadable tables.
- This PDF does not include live weather, cloud, smoke, local obstruction or artificial sky brightness.

Web data index: `data/index.html`